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DREAM MACHINE | Creative AI News & Insight { June 2026 -

Welcome to edition 32

Keeping an eye on developments, debates, news and tools across AI in the Creative Industries: covering Film, Music, Games, Media and Entertainment.

Created and curated by [DreamLab](#), a collective studio of artists, creative technologists, directors, games & software developers based in the UK..... including Emmy winners, PhD researchers, and BAFTA-recognised creative talent working at the cutting edge of creative technology.

You can also listen to this newsletter as a podcast 🎧, where you can find lots of [bonus deep dives](#) into particular topics. And do check out our [Dream Machine Book](#) - over 300 pages of analysis and fieldnotes from this newsletter, updated regularly.

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Editor's Pick: AI Isn't Coming To Hollywood. It's Already There.

The most important story this week isn't Scorsese. It's not Amazon. It's not the first AI-generated feature heading to a major festival. It's all of them.

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Across film, television, games and music, AI is quietly (or loudly perhaps) shifting from experimentation to infrastructure. Some creators are embracing it fully. Others are pushing back hard. Lots of people are still hiding their use of it. But the debate itself reveals something important: AI is no longer a future trend. It's fastly becoming part of the now in creative pipelines, and new models of licensing with.

This week's headlines read like a snapshot of an industry negotiating its future in real time. Scorsese is using AI storyboards. Amazon is funding AI animation while simultaneously facing backlash over it. Netflix is exploring AI-powered discovery. Hasbro is licensing iconic characters for AI voice generation with 'behavioural licensing'. Meanwhile, artists, directors and musicians continue to question what is gained—and what might be lost, how they need to navigate change, threat and opportunity.

The other interesting signal this week comes from Hasbro, who have rolled out their behavioural licensing model - through with partnerships with Elevenlabs- where developers and creators will be able to license iconic characters..... including transformers, peppa pig and more. This sends a really interesting signal to what is likely to become widespread standards over the coming months and years- as well as the exciting new forms of participation, fan engagement with IP & storyworlds.

The technology is improving. The investments are accelerating. People are figuring out how to work within the challenges. The arguments are getting louder, and bifurcated.

That usually means one thing: the transition has firmly already begun.



Add a caption (optional)

Film, TV, Broadcast & Animation

- Martin Scorsese Backs AI Company and Says He's Using It to Storyboard Movies: 'We Have to Be Open to How' Cinema Can 'Evolve' [LINK](#)
- Martin Scorsese gets backlash after endorsing 'creatively freeing' AI [LINK](#)
- A major film festival will soon debut the first fully AI-generated feature, inspired by real events. This could be a major shift for filmmaking [LINK](#)
- 'The CGI would have cost millions. I spent \$2,000.' Is Dreams of Violets AI slop – or the future of film-making? [LINK](#)
- Hasbro Launching an AI Studio That Will Let Companies License Its Stable of Characters [LINK](#)
- AI Drives Lenovo's 2026 FIFA World Cup Broadcast Plans [LINK](#)
- AI-generated Winston Churchill joins BBC Question Time panel [LINK](#)

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- VANDAL Partners With UTS to Explore Gen-AI's Animation Potential [LINK](#)
- 300,000 Poses in an AI Instant: My Visit to Disney Studios and the New Reality for Animation [LINK](#)
- Amazon Launching AI Creators Fund, Picks Up Three Animated Prime Video Shows That Use Its New Tech [LINK](#) then this happens...Amazon's AI-Generated Animated Series Canceled After Relentless Derision [LINK](#) Director drops out of Amazon AI series after receiving intense online backlash [LINK](#)
- Netflix Uses Generative AI and Recommendation Engine Technology to Simplify Content Discovery [LINK](#)
- 'Backrooms' Director Kane Parsons Says Using AI 'Defeats the Purpose' of Filmmaking: 'I Get No Enjoyment From Using Those Tools' [LINK](#)
- Netflix's U.K. Unscripted Chief Warns of Dangers of Using AI in Reality Shows: 'It's Hard Now to Tell What Is Fake and What Is Real' [LINK](#)
- Hollywood's AI Appetite Has Sped Up – Here's What's on the Menu | Analysis [LINK](#)

Games, Immersive & Interactive

- Roblox announces the acquisition of Morpheus AI Inc., an AI lab building video world models – strategic step toward advancing the Roblox Reality vision [LINK](#)
- Tripo AI raises nearly \$200M in financing for AI 3D and world model tech [LINK](#)
- AI Game Creation Platform Aippy Announces Tens of Millions at \$250M Valuation [LINK](#)
- Teaching AI agents to ask better questions by playing "Battleship" [LINK](#)
- Tomb Raider: Legacy Of Atlantis devs reveal AI use after State Of Play trailer [LINK](#)
- Newcastle United Adds Immersive AI Fan Engagement Platform from Lenovo and Invisionary [LINK](#)

Music & Sound

- ElevenLabs Partners With Hasbro's AI Studios to License Transformers, Mr. Potato Head, Peppa Pig and More for AI Use [LINK](#)
- AI music startup Suno raises \$400m funding at \$5.4 billion valuation [LINK](#)
- AI music-videos startup Neural Frames hits \$5m annual run rate [LINK](#)
- The End of Passive Listening: Miquido Identifies Massive Market Gaps in Music & Entertainment with "Soundscapes of 2026" Report [LINK](#)
- Has SoundCloud Cracked Superfandom and AI Music? [LINK](#)
- Musician Ben Etches has gone from playing Glastonbury with Seb Lowe to building Sineco, an AI-powered music startup developing audio that responds to the listener's body [LINK](#)
- Alice Cooper berates AI music: 'It has no emotion, heart or soul' [LINK](#)
- Could AI music help to solve a gap in culture? [LINK](#)
- Musician uses AI to make new album as Parkinson's affects ability to play guitar [LINK](#)

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- Meet the ElevenLabs ElevenHacks #10 winners - including Oneblink- a Chrome extension that reads any screen aloud for blind users, interactive teachers that output animations, and language level tracking tools [LINK](#)

+ More AI News

- Luma Announces The Open Physical AI Lab: An Open Science Effort to Solve Generalization in Physical AI [LINK](#)
- Runway Opens London HQ, Bringing World Model Research Hub to the UK and Europe [LINK](#)
- Nvidia announces new AI chip for personal computers [LINK](#)
- 2.5bn people are now using Google's AI overviews in search [LINK](#)
- AI won't decimate the arts. We must interrogate it, but we can collaborate with it [LINK](#)
- Culture secretary Nandy: Government "got it wrong" on AI and creative copyright [LINK](#)



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Tool Spotlight

Cosmos 3

- NVIDIA Cosmos 3 connects understanding, generation, simulation, and action through a shared omnimodal world model that moves fluidly across text, images, video, audio, and actions. [LINK](#)

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Claude in ComfyUI - nice

- Anthropic's Claude is now available as a partner node in ComfyUI. [LINK](#)
 - Introducing the SpAltial API to help you build immersive 3D worlds programmatically. [LINK](#)
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Higgsfield Adobe Plugins

- Higgsfield plugins for Adobe Premiere Pro and After Effects are live. [LINK](#)
- Bernini is a new AI video generation + editing framework from Bytedance [LINK](#)

TripoSpat

- TripoSplat from Tripo: a fully open-sourced model under the MIT license that converts a single 2D image into high-quality 3D Gaussians [LINK](#)

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- Vlo is a free, local, open source video editor with ComfyUI-backed generative AI features. [LINK](#)

PaGeR from Google & Meta

- Google & Meta release PaGeR, a new AI model for 360° scene geometry [LINK](#)
- A Single Primitive to Rule Them All: SuperFit at CVPR 2026 Compresses 3D Shapes into Editable Building Blocks [LINK](#)

Runway Aleph 2.0

- Aleph 2.0 is now available via the Runway API. Bring precise video editing directly into your apps, products and platforms. [LINK](#)
- Google shares guidance on visual AI generation - improve your prompts [LINK](#)

- NVIDIA has announced that DLSS 4.5 Ray Reconstruction will officially be added in Blender 5.3 as a viewport denoiser. [LINK](#)



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Watch on

- NVIDIA's PiD upscaler tutorial (above). [LINK](#)
- You're not supposed to prompt Claude. You're supposed to build a system that prompts itself. Great tutorial on using Claude Code like a pro [LINK](#)

Odyssey Agora-1

- Odyssey releases Agora-1, a multi-agent world model. [LINK](#)
- Ideogram 4.0 is out - Download the weights, fine-tune on your own data, and run it on your hardware. Live on every Ideogram plan and the API today. [LINK](#)

- Motionfly Editor. We built Cursor for video editing. [LINK](#)
- HyperFrames from Heygen is an open-source framework for turning HTML, CSS, media, and seekable animations into deterministic MP4 videos. [LINK](#)

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- NVIDIA has released another new open source world model, called FlashDreams [LINK](#)
- Elevenlabs Introduces Dubbing v2, a revolutionary new dubbing model. [LINK](#)
- Stability AI drops Stable-Layers, a new method for splitting images into editable layers [LINK](#)

Next Time...

If you've got any recommendations, opportunities or news we need to know about for our next edition please feel free to reach out to 🙌
[dreamlab](#) 🙌



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